

Knights like stable targets

Positional Judgment

THE IDEA

Knights thrive near fixed weaknesses because their short range is less of a problem there. They can jump pawn chains and occupy blockading squares. Their effectiveness drops when targets are far apart and the route between them is slow.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A knight near a fixed isolated pawn can attack and blockade it. In an endgame with passed pawns on opposite wings, the same knight may spend too many moves switching sides while a bishop crosses the board quickly.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should you ask before trading a bishop for a knight?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Will the remaining structure be closed or open, are targets fixed or mobile, and which piece can reach them efficiently? Also check tactical reasons that override the structural preference.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Choose the minor piece that fits the future pawn map.